

February

28

Born this day

1890 Vaslav Nijinsky, Russian ballet dancer and choreographer. Known as the God of Dance, he used his creative ideas and athletic physique to transform the role of men in ballet.

202 BCE

Han Dynasty

Four centuries of the Han Dynasty started with the coronation of Liu Bang as Emperor Gaozu of Han. Born a peasant, Liu Bang became an influential leader who brought peace and prosperity to China.

DNA structure

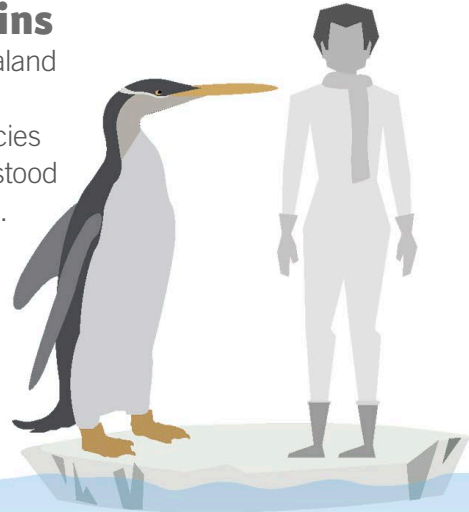
Using images of deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) taken by British scientist Rosalind Franklin, fellow scientists James Watson and Francis Crick revealed the double helix structure of DNA, announcing their discovery on this day. Their mapping of the DNA molecule helped scientists understand how genes pass between generations of families.

1953

2012

Prehistoric penguins

Fossils found in New Zealand turned out to be *Kairuku grebneffi*, an extinct species of giant penguin, which stood almost as tall as humans. This bird lived 27 million years ago when much of the country was underwater.



Also on this day

1897 Queen Ranavalona III was forcibly removed as the last monarch of Madagascar by French troops who took over the island in the Indian Ocean.

1935 US chemist Wallace Carothers invented nylon. This strong synthetic fabric was used to make stockings, as well as ropes and parachutes during World War II.

1991 The Gulf War ceasefire was declared by US president George H W Bush after Iraq withdrew from Kuwait.

